

text-type could not have existed before its earliest extant representative [!]. For many years, I have heard people repeating the evident stupidity that because there are no early Byzantine MSS the Byzantine text cannot be early, and they are still doing it. This is based on the obviously false assumption that the surviving MSS from the earliest centuries are representative of the total manuscript situation at that time.

The only surviving ‘edifices’ in Egypt that are 4,000 years old are the pyramids. Will anyone be so ridiculous as to argue that a pyramid was the only type of structure used in Egypt at that time? How many Egyptians at that time lived in pyramids? Absolutely none, because pyramids were only for the dead. But did ordinary people get a pyramid for a tomb? Only a pharaoh could afford one. We can say with total certainty that pyramids are not representative of the totality of structures in Egypt 4,000 years ago, even though they are the only ones that have survived. I would say that it is equally certain that the earliest MSS are not representative of the manuscript situation at the time. (They are the resting place of ‘dead’ forms of the NT Text, much like the pyramids.)

I do not know even the name of any of my great, great grandfathers, and I have no artifacts that they used. Yet I can state with total certainty that they existed. How can I do that? I can do that because I am here, because I exist. I could not exist without great, great grandfathers. My body contains some of their genes, their DNA. Just because I did not exist 400 years ago, does not mean that none of my ancestors did. Is that not perfectly obvious?

In 1976 Dr. Jakob van Bruggen published *The Ancient Text of the New Testament* (Winnipeg: Premier Printing Ltd.). It contains a chapter on ‘The Age of the Byzantine Type’ that occupies pages 22 – 29. He marshals a variety of arguments to show that the Byzantine text-type must be older than its surviving representatives. I will limit myself to quoting just one paragraph (page 25).

What conditions must be satisfied if we wish to award the prize to the older majuscules? While asking this question we assumed wittingly or unwittingly that we were capable of making a fair comparison between manuscripts in an earlier period and those in a later period. After all, we can only arrive at positive statements if that is the case. Imagine that someone said: in the Middle Ages mainly cathedrals were built, but in modern times many small and plainer churches are being built. This statement seems completely true when we today look around in the cities and